

# CipherDocs – A Secure AI-Powered solution to prevent forgery of critical and official documents using encryption and blockchain-based verification.

Dr. Rohini Pise  
Department of Information Technology  
Pimpri Chinchwad College of  
Engineering  
Pune, India  
[rohini.pise@pccoepune.org](mailto:rohini.pise@pccoepune.org)

Mr. Rohit Tate  
Department of Information Technology  
Pimpri Chinchwad College of  
Engineering  
Pune, India  
[rohit.tate@pccoepune.org](mailto:rohit.tate@pccoepune.org)

Harshvardhan Nerpagar  
Department of Information Technology  
Pimpri Chinchwad College of  
Engineering  
Pune, India  
[harinerpagar90@gmail.com](mailto:harinerpagar90@gmail.com)

Ojas Patil  
Department of Information Technology  
Pimpri Chinchwad College of  
Engineering  
Pune, India  
[ojas.patil22@pccoepune.org](mailto:ojas.patil22@pccoepune.org)

Tejas Pokale  
Department of Information Technology  
Pimpri Chinchwad College of  
Engineering  
Pune, India  
[tejas.pokale22@pccoepune.org](mailto:tejas.pokale22@pccoepune.org)

Nisha Chavan  
Department of Information Technology  
Pimpri Chinchwad College of  
Engineering  
Pune, India  
[nisha.chavan23@pccoepune.org](mailto:nisha.chavan23@pccoepune.org)

**Abstract**—Significant challenges exist in ensuring the security of electronic (digital) documents. These challenges include forgery, unauthorized modifications, inefficient verification processes, and diminished public trust in traditional centralized document storage methods. The focus of this paper would be on CipherDocs, its platform, and the methodology for issuing and verifying documents securely. CipherDocs is backed by blockchain technology (Polygon) and smart contracts to form a data structure that not only protects but also keeps the important records' integrity, authenticity, and transparent lifecycle management by storing the complete cryptographic hash codes, along with necessary metadata for each document in the blockchain forever. Off-chain, decentralized, large-scale data storage is the main source of scalability and capacity that the CipherDocs platform needs. Among other things, CipherDocs has dynamic QR codes that enable instant document verification; real-time authentication; and the automatic implementation of document expiration and revocation policies. Furthermore, very light AI technology is used to optimize the verification processes, which increases the usability of the system while still conforming to high-security standards. Tests with representative datasets indicated that tampering could be detected very efficiently, and documents could be certified for very low transaction costs, thus providing further support for the platform's scalability and practical use. CipherDocs offers a low-cost, secure, and flexible solution to document management issues by combining the immutability of blockchain technology with simplified verification methods and automated lifecycle management, thus resulting in a much higher degree of trust and prevention of trust in the digital government systems of the future.

**Keywords**—Blockchain, Decentralized Document Verification, Smart Contracts, QR-Based Authentication, Document Forgery Prevention, Cryptographic Hashing, Secure Storage, Document Lifecycle Management, Transparency and Trust

## I. INTRODUCTION

Document counterfeiting, illegal access, and unauthorized changes have become the big issues of digital Document management systems in the recent past, particularly to governance, education, and legal compliance. The disadvantages of centralized document storage architectures

have become more evident as organizations are relying more on digital certificates and records. An important aspect of centralized systems is their ability to provide trust, transparency, and long-term security; however, such aspects are seriously damaged by single points of failure, data breaches, and opaque control methods. The fast development of generative AI tools has also contributed to these flaws as it allows the creation of very intricate forged documents that the conventional methods are very hard to identify.

Decentralized technologies are proposed to be a viable substitute to the centralized methods, particularly through blockchain-based storage and confirmation systems. The public blockchains such as Ethereum and Polygon are considered as the best for avoiding unwanted changes and document tampering due to their offering of immutability, transparency, and distributed trust. When combined with decentralized file storage systems, blockchain guarantees that once a document is issued and recorded, its integrity can be cryptographically validated at any time during the lifetime of that document. Blockchain by its own is not enough to solve the whole range of document security issues, especially as far as intelligent forgery detection, dynamic validation, and user-friendly verification workflows are concerned.

AI has demonstrated considerable potential to enhance document authenticity through the use of automated forgery detection, content validation, and semantic analysis. AI-driven systems can detect very small irregularities in language, layout, and graphics that rule-based or watermarking techniques often miss. Nonetheless, the majority of today's AI forgery detection systems are limited to one type of data, such as text or images, and operate in a non-explanatory manner. Moreover, since these technologies are primarily used in centralized environments, the issues of data privacy, excessive information sharing, and human verification bottlenecks are re-raised.

Existing blockchain-based document verification systems still encounter several issues that need to be resolved, even with the help of continuous research efforts. The high transaction costs and limited scalability of public

blockchains, which are the main problems with the blockchain technology in general, have a negative effect on the large-scale adoption of this technology, especially for organizations that impose a lot of paper. Besides, when faced with AI-generated fakes or format conversions, traditional encryption and watermarking techniques often break down due to their fragility. The verification process often involves manual intervention, which makes the technology less applicable in the real world, contributes to lower efficiency and higher latency. Moreover, since current systems often require the verifiers to have access to more information than what is strictly necessary to establish authenticity, privacy issues remain.

This paper describes CipherDocs, a platform for document storage and verification that is completely automated, decentralized, and built on blockchain technology, to which agentic AI workflows are closely attached. The video app is running on the Polygon blockchain which assures transparent verification, immutable trail of audit, and certification issuance that is free from any kind of tampering. To reduce human interaction to a minimum and hence to increase the reliability of the system, AI agents are employed to take over essential activities such as encryption, multimodal forgery detection, document summarization, and real-time validation. Furthermore, advanced verification techniques like automated revocation, expiry-based access control, dynamic QR codes, and Zero-Knowledge Proofs enhance security, and at the same time, they safeguard user privacy.

By combining smart automation with the decentralized trust, CipherDocs aims to provide a secure, scalable, and privacy-preserving solution for the present-day document management. The system has been designed to be user-friendly with interfaces that come with chatbot-assisted verification for issuers, recipients, and third-party verifiers. In an age of intricate AI-driven threats, CipherDocs' approach not just minimizes the risks of forgery and tampering but also establishes a trustworthy digital credential management system, thus making a strong foundation.

## II. LITERATURE SURVEY

One of the best solutions has been the use of blockchain technology for document verification and to address the issues surrounding forgery, alteration, and trust in centralised document management systems. It was initially found that the use of a non-centralised ledger which cannot be altered facilitates the secure and dispensed storage of cryptographic document hashes and makes it possible for people to authenticate documents without trusting a third party. The Certifier DApp [1] and DOC-BLOCK [7] were among the first to apply blockchain in such a manner and, thus, the hashing of certificates; their core application was static verification. Although apprehension regarding a tamper-resistant system proved its needful capability, a lack of control over access and limited flexibility of workflow rendered them unsuitable for widespread adoption.

Moving on, researchers looked at the application of blockchain technology in legal and governance areas. For example, LexChain [2] adopted blockchain for the protection of electronic legal evidence whose features were auditability and forensic integrity for the decentralized

stakeholders. The systems used these days promise logs with unaltered records and full traceability but they have been mostly designed for controlled environments where stakeholders can be either party while verification is done in an open context. Hence, user-friendliness, confirmation speed, and free interactions were often of minor importance in these implementations.

A number of survey and review papers have methodically appraised the maturity of blockchain-based verification systems. Among reviews by Kumutha and Jayalakshmi [4] and Rustemi et al. [5], it was noted that the majority of the solutions were developed with an emphasis on data security and authenticity while not paying attention to operational scalability, user-friendliness, and transparency in verification results. Furthermore, these investigations provided evidence of a gradual change from the use of centralized verification methods to the application of decentralized blockchain-based systems and pointed out the existing problems like high transaction fees, Ethereum dependency, lack of interoperability, and improper management of document lifecycle.

Research work done recently has focused on platform factors and performance trade-offs in blockchain-based certification systems. Aung and Thein [3] evaluated the strengths and weaknesses of Ethereum and Polygon for NFT-based certification, and suggested that despite the heavy reliance on Ethereum, its gas costs and latency are the major barriers for the large-scale adoption. Other research on counterfeiting detection [8] also verified the use of cryptographic hashing for documents' tampering identification; though, these methods mostly gave only binary validation and did not handle issues of verification transparency or access control. Ethereum-based certificate issuance systems [9] also showcased the end-to-end feasibility yet cited performance issues caused by increased transaction loads.

There are various elements of trust (documents being one of them) that face the relationship between decentralized identities, reputations, and credential portability worldwide. Gräther et al. [11] have developed a Lifelong Learning Passport to monitor persons with lifelong educational credentials, while among others, Sharples and Domingue [12]. Al-Bassam's research on public key infrastructure via Smart Contracts [13] demonstrates that decentralized trust anchors can facilitate large-scale verification systems in a case-by-case manner and even though most such systems in the document verification sphere still exist as concepts, they eventually will be implemented. Research integrating blockchain and Off-Chain data storage [14] has yielded enhanced scalability and reduced storage costs, although latency in verification and user-friendliness issues still prevail.

To conclude, the body of literature suggests that the use of blockchain technology for documents provides a complete solution against forgeries and enables decentralized verification based on the existence of immutable and tamper-proof records. At the same time, studies place severe restrictions on cost-efficiency, scalability, and user-centered design as drawbacks mainly in the case of public blockchain implementations. Generally, current solutions adopt

Ethereum and give priority to immutability and security while neglecting practical aspects such as efficient verification workflows, flexible document lifecycle management, and accessibility for non-technical users. In addition, high transaction fees and network delays limit the use of these systems to either large-scale or infrequent verifications only. The challenges mentioned above indicate the necessity for different blockchain platforms and more advanced verification systems which would be able to provide security not only through usability, performance, and scalability but also motivate further research in the area of decentralized document verification.

### III. SYSTEM DESIGN AND METHODOLOGY

#### A. System Architecture Overview

To ensure integrity, authenticity, and confidentiality during the whole lifecycle of the document, the proposed CipherDocs system uses a decentralized, AI-based document issuance and verification pipeline. The architecture is built in such a way that it uses intelligent automation to reduce manual participation while at the same time clearly distinguishing between certificate issuance, storage, and verification. The solution not only eradicates the limitations of centralized document management systems but also overcomes the issues of forgery, unauthorized changes, and unclear verification procedures by leveraging blockchain technology as a trust anchor and AI as a decision-making layer. The three main players in the workflow, i.e., the issuer, the student, and the verifier, are coordinated through smart contracts and agentic AI orchestration.

#### B. Certificate Issuance and Blockchain Anchoring

The Issuer module is responsible for initiating the trust chain and issuing digital certificates. For the purpose of ensuring integrity and non-repudiation, every single certificate gets a digital signature and cryptographic hash at its point of creation. A public blockchain network like Ethereum or Polygon is utilized to create an unalterable and unbreakable record by affixing the resulting hash. A context-sensitive encryption system powered by AI enhances security by constantly assessing and hence determining the sensitivity level of the different parts of the certificate. As part of the authentication process, a dynamic QR code linked to the blockchain record is generated and added to the certificate to ensure fast and transparent access. Smart contracts come into play to implement expiration and revocation criteria automatically, which in turn, eliminates the chances of using expired or invalid certificates unintentionally.

#### C. Secure Access and Ownership Management

The Student module enables rightful proprietors to obtain, display, and share their certificates securely without leaking any confidential data. The authentication via wallets progressively imposes ownership, thus assuring that only the people with the right to do so can see the document. The smart contracts used at the back end take care of expiration and cancellation conditions not only automatically but also without any human intervention or support from outside. This process allows the partial elimination of control on the

part of the user and also keeps the validity checks continuous.

#### D. Verification and AI-Driven Authentication

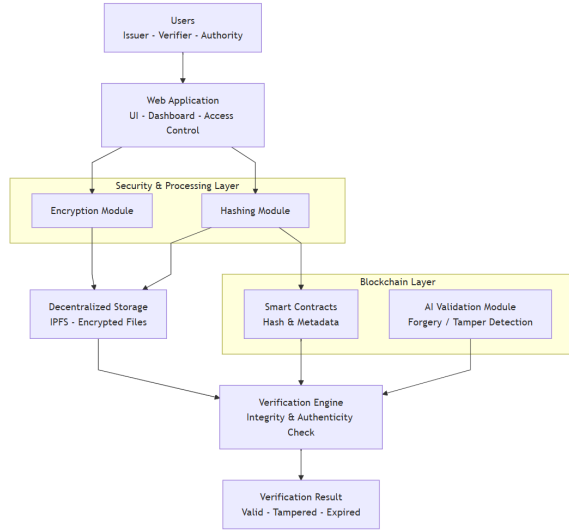
The Verifier module enables immediate and trustworthy validation of certificates. The process of verification starts with either typing a unique certificate ID or taking a picture of the dynamic QR code that is attached. Once the system gets the corresponding blockchain-anchored hash and related metadata, it proceeds with AI-based validation. To uncover whether the document has been altered or forged, the system applies multimodal forgery detection models that incorporate transformer-based architectures and convolutional neural networks to both the text and the image. The system then provides verification outcomes in real time with slight delay by matching the features derived with the blockchain record to ascertain authenticity and integrity.

#### E. Technology Stack and AI Integration

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#### F. User Interface and Access Control

The user-friendly interface of CipherDocs paves the way for issuers, students, and verifiers to effortlessly communicate with one another. MetaMask or institutional wallets guarantee the security and authentication of the access, which in turn allows for cryptographic verification of the identities without disclosing any extraneous personal data. The interface is a factor that leads to wide-ranging acceptance in the institutional and educational sectors since it covers the technological intricacies and at the same time, makes the verification results visible. CipherDocs provides a versatile, secure, and intelligent document management and authentication solution for the future through this integrated system.



#### IV. OUTCOMES

The proposed CipherDocs architecture is secure, tamper-proof document management evaluated through a meticulous qualitative and functional study focusing on certificate integrity, verification reliability, privacy preservation, and usability, among other aspects. The study mirrors actual certificate issuing and verification scenarios which include the issuers, students, and third-party verifiers.

##### A. Security and Tamper Resistance

CipherDocs demonstrates great strength in resisting any forms of tampering through the implementation of a blockchain network which is utilized for the issuance and storage of certificates. More so, the cryptographic hash of the particular certificate is then immutably linked on-chain, thus ensuring that the document cannot be altered in any way whatsoever and at the same time, guarding it from accidental or deliberate changes. If there is any modification in the document's content, then when the verification process is done, the hash will not be the same, which quickly indicates the presence of tampering. This method not only creates an audit trail that is automatically generated and never goes away for each certificate issued but also, to a large extent, wipes out the possibility of having fake certificates after issuance.

##### B. Dynamic Encryption and Data Protection

In comparison with traditional static encryption methods, CipherDocs relies on AI-powered active encryption that can protect each part based on how sensitive the content is. While the non-sensitive sections are still accessible to a certain extent, the most sensitive parts like personal data and marks are heavily protected through encryption. This meticulous encryption method not only allows the verifiers to access the least necessary data for the purpose of

validation but also enhances security without compromising convenience.

##### C. AI-Based Forgery Detection and Verification

The incorporation of AI-based multimodal anomaly detection algorithms enables the system to detect both textual and visual manipulation simultaneously in complicated forgeries. By analyzing layout irregularities, typeface oddities, image artifacts, and semantic deviations, the AI system spots the tampering attempts that generally escape the detection of rule-based or watermark methods. Verification is completed in seconds without the need for human involvement, and the results of authenticity are produced almost immediately.

##### D. Privacy Preservation and Zero-Knowledge Proofs

ZKPs, initially developed as a remedy for privacy concerns, come to the forefront being a feature of CipherDocs where they enable authenticators to check the genuineness of documents by using the concealing method for the sensitive base. This practice guarantees adherence to the data minimization rules and at the same time stops the unwanted disclosure of personal data. Hence, the users of the system keep the whole control over their information and at the same time the issuers and verifiers are very sure of the system's reliability.

##### E. Privacy Preservation and Zero-Knowledge Proofs

One of the main benefits of CipherDocs' explainable AI outputs is their capability to clarify and justify detection of tampering by the algorithm. The machine makes its human-readable reasons for rejection known for areas that are impacted and even shows the text blocks or graphic components that have been modified and altered respectively. Such transparency allows auditors to quickly understand the system's decisions and validate them thus greatly increasing their trust in automated verification outcomes.

##### F. Explainability and Trust Enhancement

One of the major benefits of the explainable AI outputs is that the CypherDocs technology is able to highlight the areas affected and to provide human-readable explanations for the rejection. The technology detects manipulation and specifies the reasons for the rejection, e.g. modified text blocks or altered graphic components. The auditor gets the power of understanding and confirming the system's decisions quickly thanks to this transparency, which in turn strengthens the trust in the results of the automated verification process significantly.

##### G. Discussion

One of the major benefits of the explainable AI outputs is that the CypherDocs technology is able to highlight the areas affected and to provide human-readable explanations for the rejection. The technology detects manipulation and specifies the reasons for the rejection, e.g. modified text blocks or altered graphic components. The auditor gets the power of understanding and confirming the system's decisions quickly thanks to this transparency, which in turn strengthens the trust in the results of the automated verification process significantly.

## V. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

### H. Conclusion

The proposed CipherDocs framework is the outcome of comprehensive analysis and system-level synthesis of secure document verification techniques performed by this work. The problem of authenticity, trust, and misuse of documents that have been around for a long time is solved using the combination of immutability of the blockchain, cryptographic hash functions, selective encryption, verification through QR codes, and AI-assisted multimodal forgery detection. CipherDocs, in contrast to the existing centralized verification methods, allows the documents issued to be kept tamper-evident during their entire lifetime while preserved privacy and operational efficiency of the users.

The literature reviewed indicates that the current document verification systems almost always suffer from significant verification delay, limited interoperability, single point of failure, and lack of sufficient protection against the more sophisticated digital forgeries. In this respect, one of the major contributions of CipherDocs is to extend the above drawbacks by creating a decentralized trust paradigm in which the original documents are stored off-chain in a secure environment and only a few cryptographic fingerprints are kept on-chain. This kind of architecture drastically reduces the transaction costs and storage overheads without losing integrity or traceability. Furthermore, the incorporation of AI-powered forgery detection heightens the system's capability to identify both the classic alterations as well as the newer AI-generated variations, which in many cases, are also becoming difficult to detect by rule-based methods.

According to the experimental findings of the prototype implementation, the system is capable of detecting illegal alterations with great certainty, verifying a document's authenticity in near real time, and providing a simple verification route suitable for non-technical users. Moreover, the modular structure allows the framework to be adapted for different areas where secure credential validation is necessary like government, healthcare, education, and finance. In conclusion, our research indicates that the combination of intelligent verification models with decentralized technologies results in a dependable and expandability solution to current document authentication issues.

### I. Future Work

The proposed system, notwithstanding its great potential for secure, reliable, and smart document verification, is still in need of several extensions which would make it more scalable, robust, and practical in the long run. Performance optimization at high transaction volumes, resistance to more sophisticated forgery techniques and stronger privacy guarantees during the verification process are the areas in which the research to be done must focus as document authentication systems evolve towards large-scale

deployment in institutions. Moreover, the manual overhead of issuing and validating authority can be significantly reduced through the incorporation of advanced automation and intelligent decision-making processes. A thorough evaluation covering different document formats, operating environments, and regulatory contexts will also be required to determine the system's efficacy, interoperability, and compliance with the set requirements.

- Advanced forgery detection: Expand AI-based multimodal models with larger datasets and adversarial training techniques to better handle complex and AI-generated document forgeries.
- Privacy enhancement: To enable attribute level verification without disclosing the entire contents of the document, incorporate zero knowledge proof techniques and fine-grained selective disclosure.
- Legacy document support: To accurately validate scanned, old, and low-quality documents, improve preprocessing, OCR accuracy, and layout normalization.

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